

Redefining your SMT production: Intelligent Factory

From legacy to innovation, ASMPT Limited is redefining electronics. Its India leaders reveal how intelligent factories and bold strategies are transforming global technology manufacturing. Curious? Read on.



**NEERAJ
BHARDWAJ**
General Manager
for India,
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Q. How would you explain ASMPT and its role in the electronics manufacturing ecosystem to an industry newcomer?

ASMPT Limited is a leading global supplier of hardware and software solutions for the manufacture of semiconductors and electronics. Headquartered in Singapore, ASMPT's offerings encompass the semiconductor assembly and packaging, and SMT (surface mount technology) industries, ranging from wafer deposition to the various solutions that organise, assemble and package delicate electronic components into a vast range of end-user devices, which include electronics, mobile communications, computing, automotive, industrial and LED (displays).

The mission of the SMT Solutions segment within ASMPT is to implement and support the intelligent factory at electronics manufacturers worldwide. ASMPT solutions support the connectivity, automation, and optimisation of central workflows with hardware, software and services that enable electronics manufacturers to transition to the intelligent factory in stages and enjoy dramatic improvements in productivity, quality and flexibility. With its strong commitment to Industry 4.0 and the consistent use of industrial standard interfaces, ASMPT opens the door for its customers to economically feasible automation, entirely in accordance with their individual requirements – modular, flexible, and vendor-independent.

The product range includes highly integrated hardware and software solutions, such as SIPLACE placement machines, DEK printing platforms, the Process Lens SPI system and automated storage solutions. The high-quality software portfolio includes the WORKS Software Suite, which supports all line-related workflows on the shop floor, such as planning, controlling, analysing, and optimising printing and placement processes, as well as Factory Solutions for factory-wide processes like holistic material flow optimisation. Maintaining close relationships with customers and technology partners is a central component of ASMPT's strategy.

Q. How has ASMPT's Siemens legacy helped it become a global leader?

ASMPT SMT Solutions builds on a strong legacy with SIPLACE from Siemens, DEK from the UK, and a comprehensive suite of software and factory solutions. These brands laid a solid foundation both for the company and its product portfolio. Under ASMPT, this foundation has been further developed into a complete end-to-end offering, providing integrated hardware and software solutions for both semiconductor and electronics manufacturers.

Q. How has India's market evolved for ASMPT, especially with the 'Make in India' push?

India has become a very exciting and dynamic market. The 'Make in India' initiative and the Indian government's strong support for the electronics manufacturing sector clearly demonstrate the rising investments in this area. For me, this also means more opportunities to work closely with India customers, whether they are local companies or global players, and support them with our cutting-edge solutions.

Q. Can you share some figures about the number of machines sold in India in the last few years?

We are very honoured that we have achieved a very large uptake this year, with several hundreds machine installations. Favourable market conditions have contributed to these results, and we plan to leverage this momentum to further expand our reach in India.

Q. What is ASMPT's roadmap in India, and can high machine sales be sustained year on year?

With current government's vision for India in the electronics industry, I do foresee an uptake of interest and business opportunities for ASMPT. This is also where ASMPT's intelligent factory concept comes to play, where it supports manufacturers to stay relevant and resilient for the road ahead. Being an innovative company and a technology leader, we are at the forefront to provide solutions for our customers to stay ahead.

Q. What key factors have driven ASMPT India's leadership under your guidance?

Staying relevant, providing resilient and innovative solutions that are needed by the industries have played a part. In addition, the extensive service support we have in India, to provide our customers after-sales service is also very important. I believe that excellent after-sales service is key to retaining existing customer relationships and welcoming repeated orders.



ASMPT Pick-and-Place Machines
SIPLACE TX and SIPLACE SX

Q. As ASMPT India's head, what are your mantras for motivating your team to excel?

ASMPT offers the best-in-class equipment and solutions. I believe the people working with the equipment are important as well. From sales, to technical support engineers, everyone put in our best foot forward in whatever we do. Globally, the employees of ASMPT are guided by our POWER values – passion, ownership, win, excellence, and respect. These guiding principles help us reach our goals and achieve important milestones.

Q. How do you work with channel partners to manage expectations and achieve win-win goals?

Our channel partners are like an extension of ASMPT in the market. Through regular communications, clear and smart goals defined, we work hand-in-hand to achieve our goals and orders together.

Q. How ready is India's talent for high-quality electronics manufacturing, and what initiatives have you led in this area?

Talent pool is abundant, but also competitive for employers. Many job opportunities are available for talents. Hence, as employers we need to consider talent retention, and to build a team to cope with the current demands for our customers. The government is also taking initiatives to build up a very strong supply of talents by offering relevant courses at schools and universities. We are working closely with these universities to offer students internships at ASMPT and to groom the future talents, and in turn contribute to the electronics industry in the near future.

Q. Any chance of seeing a 'Made in India' ASMPT machine in the near future?

We currently have no plans to manufacture ASMPT machines in India. However, India is a very important market for us, and we are committed to supporting our customers here in India with our latest technologies and services.